PRODUCT CASE STUDY · FOOD DELIVERY

# Solving Order Drop for FoodSwift

*How reliability failures silently churn your best users — and how to fix it*

| ↓0.4 | ↓NPS | ~₹450 | 3 |
| --- | --- | --- | --- |
| Orders/Month Drop | Trust Erosion | Avg Order Value | Root Hypotheses |

# Orders Are Falling — Quietly

FoodSwift saw a sharp metric deterioration from Jan → March. Users aren't leaving — they're ordering less. This is 'silent churn': a trust fracture that doesn't show up in uninstalls.

## 3.2 → 2.8

**Orders / Month**

12.5% drop in ordering frequency

## NPS Drop

**User Trust Score**

Ratings fell after post-March wave

## Post-Cancel

**Re-order Rate**

Low re-engagement after cancellations

**Root Cause Hypothesis:**

Post-payment order cancellations — caused by kitchen unavailability — erode user trust and reduce repeat ordering frequency over subsequent weeks.

## USER PERSONA

### The Urban Orderer

Age 20–35 · Tier-1 Cities · 2–4 orders/month

- Student / Early-career professional
- AOV ~₹450 (solo/light 2-person meals)
- Values reliability over discounts
- Does NOT uninstall — silently reduces usage

### Needs & Motivations

- Convenience-first — quick decision to order
- High expectation of fulfillment once confirmed
- Consistent, predictable delivery experience

### Pain Points

- Item unavailability discovered after payment
- Restaurant-side cancellations at peak hours
- Time wasted due to late-stage failures

### Behavioral Response to Failure

- Does not uninstall — 'silent churn'
- Reduced ordering frequency in following weeks
- Lower NPS → fewer recommendations → lower GMV

# 3 Hypotheses Explaining the Drop

## H1 January Stability Baseline

WHY

Holiday spending spill-over + return to work routines creates consistent, predictable demand

EFFECT

Higher weekday ordering, willingness to add sides, stable AOV

→ Jan = stable control period

## H2 February: Low-Ticket Solo Orders

WHY

Fewer days, fewer weekend gatherings, post-January financial tightness → necessity-driven orders

EFFECT

Lower AOV (not lower order count) — users switch to quick, solo meals

→ Basket shrink, not frequency drop

## H3 March: Capacity Mismatch & Trust Break

WHY

Fiscal year-end + exam stress spikes demand; restaurants fail to update availability dynamically

EFFECT

Late cancellations waste high-need moments

* NPS drop + frequency decline in April

→ Post-March metric deterioration

SOLUTION FRAMEWORK

# Shift Risk Detection Before Checkout

*Two-sided solution: ML reliability ratings for customers + 90-sec capacity confirmation for kitchens*

### Pre-Checkout Availability Check

- Verify kitchen capacity BEFORE payment
- Show real-time 'Checking Kitchen' screen
- Gate order confirmation on kitchen acceptance

### ML Reliability Ratings

- Score each restaurant on last 10 orders
- ≥8/10 successful = 'Highly Reliable' badge
- Below threshold = 'May Face Delays' warning

### 90-Second Kitchen Confirmation

- Kitchen gets 90s to accept/decline order
- Decline triggers instant smart reroute
- Suggest 'Highly Reliable' alternatives for same cuisine

# When the Kitchen is Ready

### 1 User Browses

Sees restaurant tagged 'Highly Reliable' based on last 10 order completion rate ≥80%

### 2 Pre-Checkout Check

App triggers kitchen availability check — verifying items, chef capacity, and delivery slot

### 3 Kitchen Accepts (90s)

Restaurant kitchen receives order & confirms capacity within 90-second window

### 4 Order Confirmed

User sees confirmation with accurate ETA + 'Kitchen is preparing your food' status

✓ **Result: Order succeeds → User trust maintained → Higher likelihood of next order**

# When the Kitchen Can't Accept

## ✕ OLD FLOW (Broken)

* User browses & selects restaurant
* Pays → Order sent to kitchen

→ **Kitchen rejects AFTER payment**

→ **User gets generic error message**

→ **Trust destroyed — no recovery path**

VS

## ✓ NEW FLOW (FoodSwift Solution)

* User browses → sees reliability rating
* Pre-checkout kitchen capacity check
* Kitchen declines within 90s (before payment)

→ **Smart reroute → suggest 'Highly Reliable' alternatives**

→ **User completes order → trust preserved**

## Core Design Principles

### Shift risk detection early
Before checkout, not after payment

### Confirmation gating
Align kitchen capacity with user intent

### Fast, transparent reroute
Replace late failures with instant alternatives

SUCCESS METRICS

# How We Know It's Working

## PRIMARY METRICS

**Orders/Month**
2.8 → 3.2
Restore pre-drop frequency

**NPS Score**
+8–12 pts
Reverse trust erosion

**Post-Cancel Re-order Rate**
+20%
Users complete order via reroute

**Order Completion Rate**
>95%
Successful first-attempt orders

## SECOND-ORDER BENEFITS

**Highly Reliable Order Share**
↑ %

☐ **Orders Confirmed in First 90s**
↑ %

**Re-order After Early Cancellation**
↑ count

☆ **Restaurant Reliability Score Dist.**
Shift up

SUMMARY

# The Core Insight

*Cancellations don't hurt because orders fail — they hurt because they fail late. The fix isn't faster delivery; it's earlier honesty.*

**01** Identify the persona: silent churners who reduce frequency, not uninstallers

**02** Root cause: late-stage cancellations during demand spikes (exam season, FY-end)

**03** Solution: ML reliability ratings + 90-sec kitchen confirmation gate

**04** Measure: restore orders/month to 3.2, improve NPS, increase post-cancel re-order rate